

TALENT ACQUISITION OPERATIONS · SELECTION SCIENCE

High-volume hiring. Evidence intact.

A governed ATS operating model for 4,000 synthetic candidates, five requisitions, structured assessment, recruiter capacity, fairness monitoring, and privacy by design.

OpenCATS model

40 / 40 / 20 composite

100% synthetic

4,000

applicants across five
requisition families

120

accepted hires · 3.0%
conversion

28.5d

mean time-to-fill

91.8%

feedback submitted within 48
hours

Decision promise: scale the workflow without hiding stage definitions, evidence weights, service levels, or cohort impact.

SYSTEM MAP

One controlled path from requisition to hire.

1**Requisition control**

Approved headcount, grade, manager, opening date, target close date, and role-specific evidence requirements.

2**Application and knockout**

Auditable eligibility rules keep demographic fields isolated from selection decisions.

3**Structured assessment**

Work sample and structured interview evidence use anchored scoring and common criteria.

4**Governed composite**

Work sample 40% + structured interview 40% + job knowledge 20%.

5**Offer, hire, and monitoring**

Capacity, turnaround, conversion, adverse impact, and override review remain visible together.

GOVERNED MEASURES

Metrics stay interpretable because their denominators stay visible.

Funnel

4,000 applied → 986 shortlisted → 500 assessed → 120 offered and hired.

Selection quality

The 40/40/20 composite prioritizes job-relevant work samples and structured evidence.

Service level

1,836 of 2,000 interview records met the 48-hour feedback standard.

Fairness signal

0.87 adverse-impact ratio at knockout progression; above the 0.80 monitoring threshold.

Capacity

Stage volume and feedback turnaround expose recruiter or interviewer bottlenecks.

Traceability

Candidate, requisition, interview, score, outcome, and disposition remain linked.

Interpretation control: the 4/5ths rule is a screening indicator, not proof that a process is legally compliant or free from bias.

RISK AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

Human judgment remains reviewable.

- **Halo-effect review:** a +0.68 subjective-versus-composite gap flags CAND-2026-0013 for review without diagnosing intent.
- **Structured rubrics:** behaviorally anchored questions, common probes, and scoring notes reduce uncontrolled variance.
- **Role-based access:** recruiters, interviewers, hiring managers, HRIS administrators, and auditors receive separated permissions.
- **Reason codes:** dispositions and overrides require documented, job-related evidence.
- **Privacy:** synthetic public data, limited fields, retention rules, and demographic separation support safe demonstration.
- **UAT:** stage transitions, permissions, formulas, exception paths, and reporting outputs have explicit acceptance checks.

Built deliverables: source datasets, data dictionary, ATS workflow and RACI, rubrics, validity model, fairness matrix, privacy matrix, UAT register, dashboard, and executive deck.

EXECUTIVE TAKEAWAY

Scale works when evidence, workflow, and accountability move together.

What leaders can decide

Where the funnel loses viable candidates, which requisitions miss service levels, and where evidence or capacity needs intervention.

What operators can run

A five-requisition workflow with clear owners, structured interviews, auditable stage gates, and paginated candidate operations.

What HRIS teams can govern

Entity relationships, permissions, reason codes, data retention, formulas, and acceptance criteria.

What the model does not claim

No causal proof, no automated employment decision, no production deployment, and no real candidate data.

Research anchor: Sackett et al. (2022) selection-method meta-analysis, applied as an evidence foundation rather than a claim of local predictive validity.